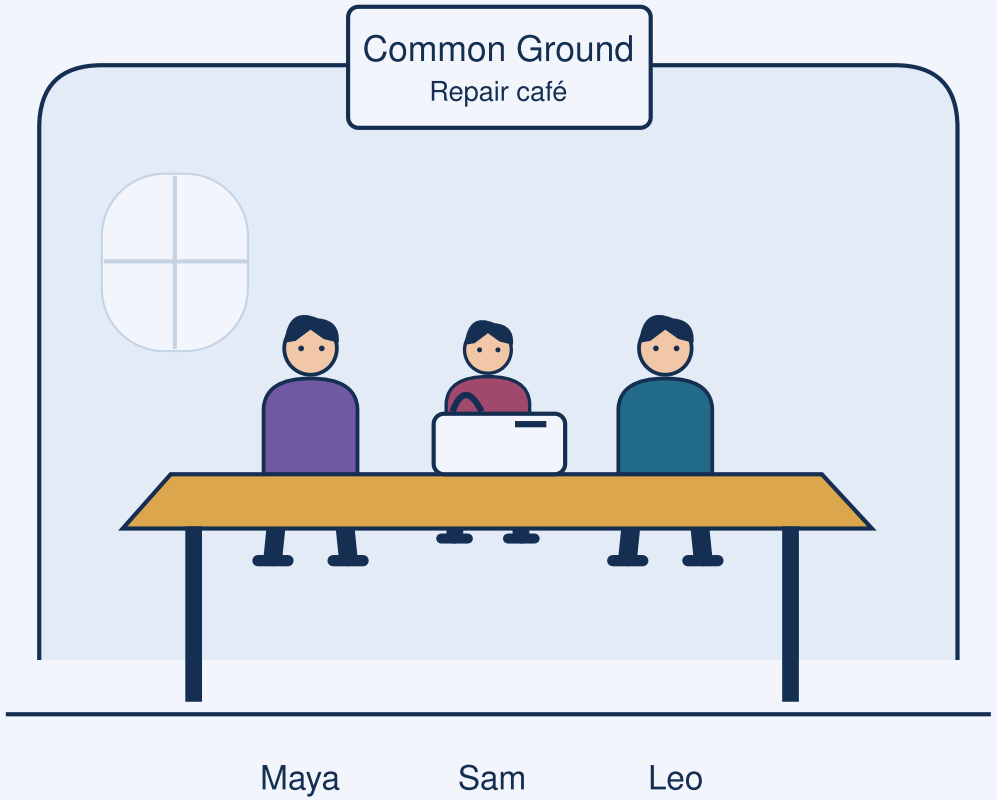
# One broken toaster becomes “they always break.”

An original story at the Common Ground repair café.






A fictional story. A real question about people.

# What would you do?

## What most improves the estimate of repeat failures?

A A detailed account of the worst failure.

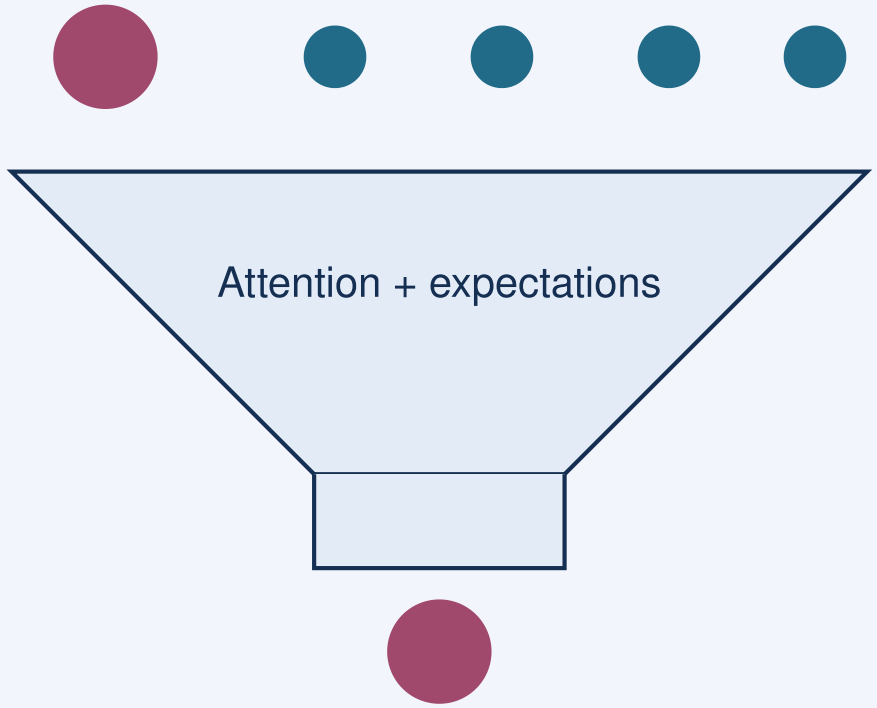
B Failures divided by comparable completed repairs.

C A vote on whose impression feels realistic.

Suggested answer: B. The denominator makes the cases interpretable; consistent follow-up still matters.

# Memorable is not the same as common.

- Availability: accessible examples shape judgment.
- Base rate: how frequent is it overall?
- Selection: which cases reach your attention?



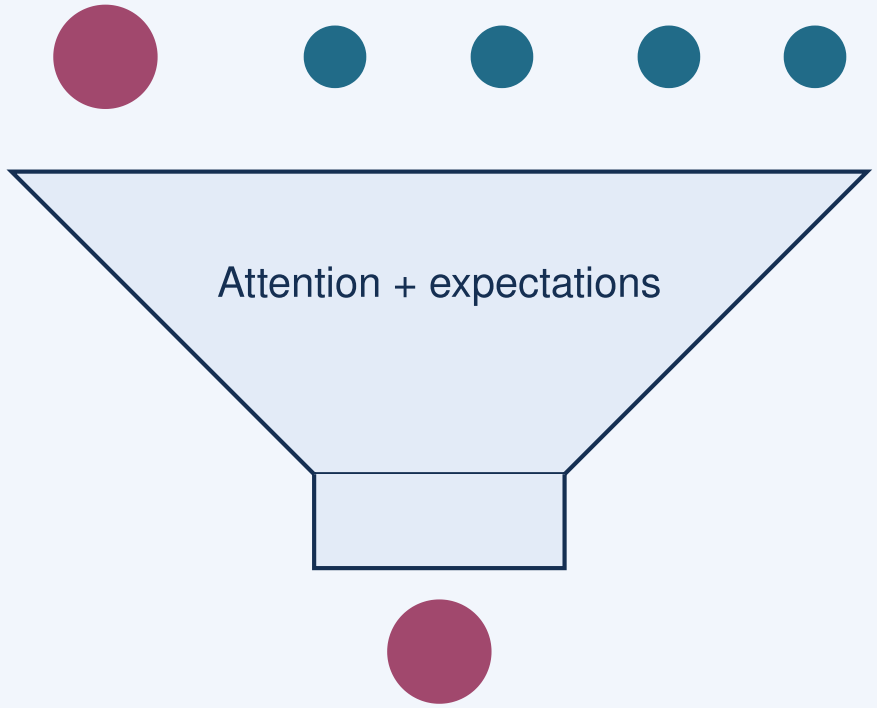

What reaches us is a selected sample.



Attention and expectations select the evidence we notice.

# Beliefs can filter their own evidence.

- Notice which evidence you seek.
- Separate interpretation from the record.
- Ask what would change your mind.

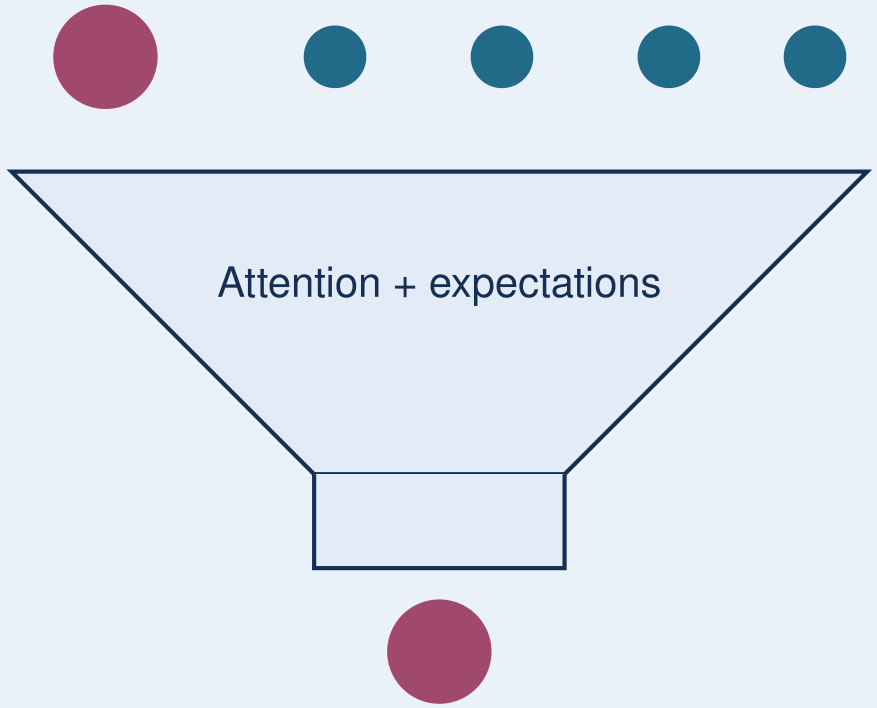



What reaches us is a selected sample.

Attention and expectations select the evidence we notice.

# What can we really conclude?

A bias name does not establish why one person made one judgment. To distinguish availability from accurate expertise, compare the judgment with relevant data. Corrective strategies are aids, not immunity. Experts also need feedback, representative records, and procedures that permit their expectations to be wrong. Personal reflection alone cannot replace those conditions.




What reaches us is a selected sample.

Conceptual illustration; no research data are plotted.

# Try the idea somewhere new.

## Leo thinks evening sessions fail. Which question best challenges his belief?

A Which evenings went badly?

B Who agrees that evenings are a poor idea?

C What outcomes would make us conclude evenings work?

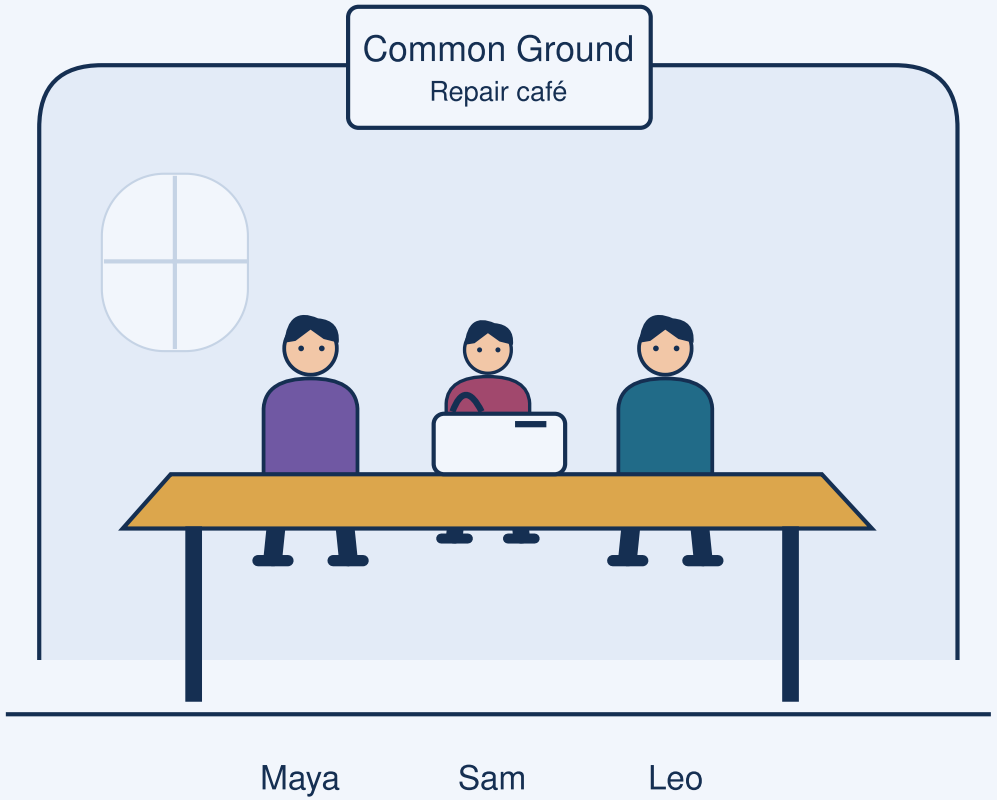
Suggested answer: C. Defining possible disconfirmation makes the belief testable.

# Close your notes. Explain it.

> Why does a vivid case need a denominator?

> When can an availability shortcut be useful?

1. Without the total of comparable cases, frequency is unknown.
2. When accessible examples reliably represent the relevant events.

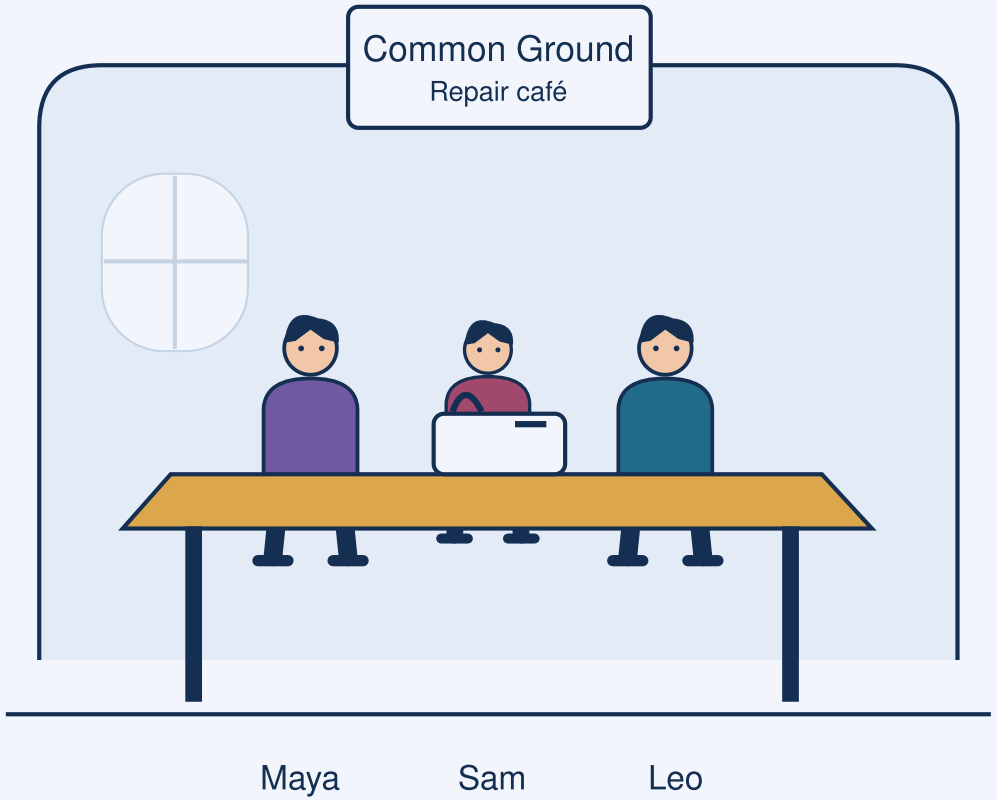



Maya, Sam and Leo at the repair café.

# Carry one idea into your week.

Keep a small record of one everyday prediction for a week. Include successes and failures. Avoid collecting private information about others. Compare the whole record with your first impression.

Revisit tomorrow and in a week.
Explain it without notes, then use a different example.






Take the question into a different setting.